

HotelTrack — Complete User Guide

Everything every role needs to know to use the platform — from the person who runs HotelTrack itself, down to the hotel owner who only sees a read-only dashboard.

Table of contents

- 1. [What HotelTrack is](#)
- 2. [The three roles + their relationships](#)
- 3. [Tracking — Pixel, snippet, or both?](#)
- 4. [Role 1 — Super Admin \(Platform Owner\)](#)
- 5. [Role 2 — Agency Owner \(Paying Customer\)](#)
- 6. [Role 3 — Hotel Owner / Hotel Client \(View-only\)](#)
- 7. [Cross-references](#)

1. What HotelTrack is

HotelTrack is a multi-tenant SaaS for **marketing agencies that manage hotel clients**. It proves that the agency's content (organic Instagram posts, paid Meta ads, influencer collaborations) drives **real bookings on the hotel's own website** — closing the loop from *content* → *visit* → *booking* → *revenue*, plus Meta ad ROI.

In one sentence: **an agency uses HotelTrack to show their hotel client exactly which marketing efforts produced paying guests.**

2. The three roles + their relationships

Role	Who they are	What they pay for	Access scope
Super Admin	The platform owner (you, the person running HotelTrack itself)	Nothing — they own the platform	Sees every agency, every hotel, every dollar
Agency Owner	A paying marketing agency	Monthly subscription via Stripe	Only their own agency's hotels + data
Hotel Owner / Hotel Client	The hotel the agency manages	Nothing — the agency pays	Only their own hotel's data, view-only, via a share link

Super Admin (1 person – runs HotelTrack itself)

- └ Agencies (N – they sign up and pay)
 - └ Hotel Clients (N per agency – the actual hotels)
 - └ Hotel Owner (sees their own dashboard via share link)

3. Tracking — Pixel, snippet, or both?

Before getting into roles, understand how website tracking works. HotelTrack supports two trackers; the agency picks which to install on their hotels' websites:

Mode (env flag NEXT_PUBLIC_TRACKING_MODE)	What's installed on hotel sites	What you get
--	------------------------------------	--------------

hoteltrack (default — recommended)	Both Meta Pixel + HotelTrack snippet	Meta's ad optimization & ROAS + HotelTrack's per-content attribution dashboards
pixel	Meta Pixel only	Meta ad reporting only; HotelTrack's attribution dashboards sit empty

The default is `hoteltrack` (dual install). Everything below assumes dual mode unless flagged otherwise.

4. Role 1 — Super Admin (Platform Owner)

Who you are

The person running HotelTrack itself — typically the founder / dev who set it up. You don't pay a subscription; you are the platform.

What you can do

- See every agency that has signed up (`/admin`)
- Suspend an agency (blocks them from `/agency/*` regardless of billing)
- Onboard yourself to any agency as `agency_admin` for hands-on debugging
- Manage env vars, deploys, the database

What you need

Requirement	Why
GitHub repo of HotelTrack	To deploy
Hosting account — Vercel or Render	Where the app runs
Production PostgreSQL database (Neon, Supabase, Vercel Postgres, Render Postgres)	Persistence
Clerk account, production instance	Auth
Stripe account in live mode + 4 price IDs	Billing
Meta Developer account + at least one app	For the agency-level <code>ads_read</code> token + per-hotel IG tokens
Resend account + verified sender domain	Alert emails
A domain name (optional but recommended)	For the tracking snippet URL

Step-by-step setup

A) Deploy the platform (one-time)

Pick **one** of the deployment docs and follow it end-to-end:

- `docs/deploying-to-vercel.md` — easier for hobbyists, faster cold starts, cron limited on Hobby plan
- `docs/deploying-to-render.md` — better for persistent connections, transparent pricing, ~\$15-20/mo

Both walk through: provision Postgres → set env vars → deploy → wire up Stripe webhook → set up cron jobs → custom domain.

B) Create your account

1. Open the deployed app → **Sign up**
2. Verify email
3. Complete onboarding (give yourself an agency name — you'll use this account as your debugging tenant)

C) Promote yourself to super admin

From your local machine, pointed at the **production** database:

```
$env:DATABASE_URL = "postgres://...prod URL..."  
npm run set:super-admin -- you@example.com
```

Sign out + back in so the new role lands in your Clerk session token.

D) Verify access

- Open `/admin` → should see your agency listed (and any others if multiple have signed up)
- You can now suspend / unsuspend any agency, view aggregate platform metrics

E) Day-to-day responsibilities

- Monitor Vercel / Render logs for errors
- Watch the Stripe dashboard for failed payments / churn
- Run `npm test` before every release (cross-agency isolation test)
- Rotate the Meta access token before it expires (long-lived tokens last ~60 days)

Super-admin pre-launch checklist

- ☐ Deploy doc completed (Vercel or Render) end-to-end
- ☐ Custom domain pointed at the deploy, SSL active
- ☐ Production Postgres provisioned + prisma migrate deploy succeeded
- ☐ All env vars set (DATABASE_URL, ENCRYPTION_KEY, CRON_SECRET, Clerk live keys, Stripe live keys, Resend)
- ☐ Stripe webhook live + STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET set
- ☐ Cron jobs visible & test-fire OK
- ☐ Clerk session token includes the `metadata` claim
- ☐ `npm test` passes (7/7 isolation tests)
- ☐ Your super-admin role granted + `/admin` accessible
- ☐ Sent yourself a test alert email → arrived

5. Role 2 — Agency Owner (Paying Customer)

Who you are

The marketing agency owner who pays for HotelTrack and uses it to track results for their hotel clients.

What you can do

- Sign up + onboard your agency
- Pay a monthly subscription
- Add unlimited hotel clients (within your plan's limit)
- Connect Meta Ads + organic Instagram per hotel
- Create UTM-tagged content links for every post / ad

- See per-hotel and agency-wide dashboards with charts + KPIs
- Export everything to Excel or CSV
- Generate read-only share links for each hotel owner
- Configure alerts (e.g. "tell me when any hotel's bookings drop > 50%")

What you need

Requirement	Why
An email for your agency account	Becomes your Clerk login
A credit card (after free demo period if any)	For Stripe subscription
A Meta access token with <code>ads_read</code>	One per agency, for paid-ad data across all hotels
(Per hotel) A separate Meta token with IG scopes — <code>instagram_basic</code> , <code>instagram_manage_insights</code> , <code>pages_show_list</code> , <code>pages_read_engagement</code>	Only if you want organic IG metrics for that hotel
(Per hotel) The hotel's Meta ad account ID (<code>act_...</code>)	To map paid spend / ROAS to the right hotel
(Per hotel) Access to install scripts on the hotel's website	Or coordinate with the hotel's developer

Step-by-step setup — INITIAL (one-time)

Step 1: Sign up

1. Open the HotelTrack URL (e.g. `https://your-domain.com`)
2. Click **Sign up** (top right)
3. Enter email + password → verify email

Step 2: Onboarding — name your agency

1. The onboarding page asks **"What's your agency called?"**
2. Type the agency name → submit
3. This creates an `Agency` record with you as `admin` , sets your Clerk role to `agency_admin`

Step 3: Pick a plan + pay

1. Top nav → **Billing**
2. Compare plans (Starter / Growth / Pro / Enterprise) by hotel-client limit + price
3. Click **Subscribe** on the plan you want → Stripe Checkout opens
4. Enter card → complete payment
5. Stripe webhook flips `subscriptionStatus` to `active` (a few seconds). If it stays `inactive` for > 1 min, the webhook isn't wired correctly — contact the super admin

Step 4: Connect Meta Ads (agency-level)

This is the one Meta connection your agency uses for **all** hotels' paid-ad data.

To get the token:

1. Open [Meta Graph API Explorer](#)
2. Select your Meta Developer app from the top dropdown
3. Click **Get Token** → **Get User Access Token**
4. Tick the `ads_read` permission

5. Click **Generate Access Token** → log into Meta → copy the token (starts with EAA...)
6. (Recommended for production) Extend the token to long-lived: paste into [Access Token Debugger](#) → Extend Access Token. Or use a Meta System User from Business Manager for a non-expiring token.

To connect it in HotelTrack:

1. Top nav → **Settings**
2. "**Meta Ads connection**" section → paste the token → **Connect Meta**
3. Token is encrypted with AES-256-GCM before storage; never sent back to your browser
4. Your ad accounts list appears, confirming the token works

Step 5 (optional): Configure alerts

1. Top nav → **Alerts**
2. Create alert rules (e.g. "any hotel's daily bookings drop > 50%")
3. Alerts fire inside the daily Meta sync cron and email via Resend

Step-by-step — PER NEW HOTEL CLIENT

Run this once for **each** new hotel you onboard. Total time: ~30-45 min on your side, plus the hotel dev's time to paste snippets.

Step 6: Create the hotel

1. Top nav → **Hotel Clients** → + **Add Hotel Client**
2. Fill in:
 - Hotel name (e.g. Seaside Resort)
 - Website URL (https://seasideresort.com)
 - Contact name + contact email
 - **How is a booking confirmed?**
 - **Redirects to a new page** — pattern like /booking/confirmation (wildcards allowed)
 - **Shows confirmation on same page** — a unique success phrase or CSS selector
 - **Both / not sure** — fill in both options
3. Submit → you land on the hotel's setup page

Step 7: Install BOTH trackers on the hotel website

This is the most important step. Two snippets go into `<head>` of every page; they don't conflict.

7a — HotelTrack snippet (from the setup page)

1. Scroll to "Install the tracking snippet"
2. Copy the one-line `<script>` :

```
<script src="https://your-domain.com/t.js?id=site_XXXXXX" async></script>
```

7b — Meta Pixel (from Meta Events Manager)

1. Open [Meta Events Manager](#)
2. + **Connect data source** → **Web** → **Meta Pixel** → name it after the hotel → enter URL
3. Choose **Install code manually** → copy the ~10-line `<script>` block

7c — Hand BOTH to the hotel's developer

Tell them to paste both blocks just before `</head>` on **every page**:

```
<head>
  <!-- ...hotel's own meta tags, fonts, CSS... -->
```

```

<!-- Meta Pixel -->
<script>
  !function(f,b,e,v,n,t,s)
  {if(f.fbq)return;n=f.fbq=function(){n.callMethod?
  n.callMethod.apply(n,arguments):n.queue.push(arguments)};
  if(!f._fbq)f._fbq=n;n.push=n;n.loaded=!0;n.version='2.0';
  n.queue=[];t=b.createElement(e);t.async=!0;
  t.src=v;s=b.getElementsByTagName(e)[0];
  s.parentNode.insertBefore(t,s)}(window, document, 'script',
  'https://connect.facebook.net/en_US/fbevents.js');
  fbq('init', 'YOUR_PIXEL_ID');
  fbq('track', 'PageView');
</script>
<noscript></noscript>
<!-- End Meta Pixel -->

<!-- HotelTrack -->
<script src="https://your-domain.com/t.js?id=site_XXXXXX" async></script>
</head>

```

7d — Add Purchase event on booking confirmation page (Pixel only)

HotelTrack auto-detects bookings via the conversion method (Step 6). Meta Pixel needs an explicit call **on the confirmation page only**:

```

<script>
  fbq('track', 'Purchase', { value: 12500, currency: 'INR' });
</script>

```

...where `12500` is filled in by the hotel's templating engine with the actual booking amount.

Step 8: Map the hotel to its Meta ad account

1. Top nav → **Settings**
2. **"Map ad accounts to hotels"** section → find this hotel → pick its `act_...` from the dropdown → save
3. The hourly cron now pulls spend / ROAS / conversions for this hotel

Skip if the hotel doesn't run paid Meta ads — the Paid Ads section of their dashboard will just sit empty.

Step 9 (optional): Connect organic Instagram

Skip if the hotel doesn't have a Business/Creator IG, or you don't care about organic metrics.

1. Back on the hotel's setup page → scroll to **"Instagram (organic social)"**
2. Generate a fresh Meta access token with **all four** of these scopes:
 - `instagram_basic`
 - `instagram_manage_insights`
 - `pages_show_list`
 - `pages_read_engagement`
3. Paste the token → **Find Instagram accounts**
4. Pick the right IG account for this hotel → **Connect Instagram**

5. **Sync insights now** (or wait for the 6-hourly cron)

Step 10: Create UTM-tagged content pieces

This is what powers "which Instagram reel drove this booking" attribution.

For **every** post / reel / ad / story you publish for this hotel:

1. Top nav → **Content** → + **New Content Piece**
2. Select this hotel
3. Title (e.g. `Sunset Rooftop Reel`)
4. Content type: Organic / Paid ad / Influencer collab / Story
5. Platform: Instagram / Facebook / YouTube
6. Destination URL (where the link lands — usually a room or booking page)
7. (*Influencer collab only*) Influencer name + coupon code
8. Click **Generate tracked link**

You get a URL like:

```
https://seasideresort.com/rooms?utm_source=instagram&utm_medium=organic&utm_campaign=sunset-rooftop-reel&utm_content=ht-abc123&utm_term=agency_xyz
```

Use that link in the post — Instagram bio link, Linktree, story link sticker, ad destination URL, influencer caption.

Step 11: Verify everything works

1. **Snippet status:** `/agency/hotels` → status badge flips to `live` within seconds of first visit
2. **Test booking:** open the website in incognito via a UTM link → complete a booking → within seconds, hotel dashboard KPIs increment; Meta Events Manager → Test Events → shows the events
3. **Meta data lands in ~1 hour:** Paid Ads section populates after the next cron run
4. **IG data lands in ~6 hours:** Social Media section populates after the next cron run (or click Sync insights now)

Step 12: Generate a read-only share link for the hotel owner

1. On the hotel dashboard → scroll to "**Share with the hotel**"
2. Click **Generate share link**
3. (*Optional*) Set expiry + password
4. Copy the `https://your-domain.com/share/<uuid>` link → send to the hotel contact

Agency owner daily / weekly workflow

- **Daily:** glance at agency dashboard for KPI changes; check Alerts inbox
- **Weekly:** export the per-hotel report as PDF / Excel from the hotel dashboard → email to each hotel owner; review content performance and double-down on top performers
- **Monthly:** review your subscription usage (hotel count vs plan limit) under Billing

Agency owner pre-onboarding checklist (per hotel)

- Step 6 – Create hotel in HotelTrack with correct conversion method
- Step 7a – Copy HotelTrack snippet from setup page
- Step 7b – Create Meta Pixel in Events Manager → copy base code
- Step 7c – Hand BOTH snippets to hotel dev → in `<head>` of every page
- Step 7d – `fbq('Purchase')` on the booking confirmation page
- Step 8 – Map hotel to its Meta ad account
- Step 9 – (*Optional*) Connect Instagram

- Step 10 – Create content pieces with tracked links for every post/ad
- Step 11 – Test booking → verify both Meta + HotelTrack capture it
- Step 12 – Generate share link → send to hotel owner

6. Role 3 — Hotel Owner / Hotel Client (View-only)

Who you are

The hotel that the marketing agency is managing. The agency does the work; you see the results.

What you can do

- **View** your hotel's marketing dashboard via a private read-only share link the agency sends you
- See visits, bookings, revenue per content piece
- See paid-ad ROAS, organic Instagram growth, influencer coupon performance
- Open on phone or desktop — **no login required**, no app to install
- The link can have a password and an expiry date

What you can't do

- Edit any data
- See other hotels (not even other hotels managed by the same agency)
- Add content, change settings, etc.

What you need

Requirement	Why
The share link from your agency	That's how you access the dashboard
(Optional) Password the agency set on the link	They'll send it separately
A modern browser	Anything from the last 3 years works

If you're the **hotel's web admin / developer**, you may also be asked to:

Paste two <script> tags in <head> of every page	What enables the tracking. The agency sends them — one is the HotelTrack snippet, one is the Meta Pixel
Add an fbq('Purchase', { value, currency }) call on the booking confirmation page	What tells Meta a booking happened
(One-time) Upgrade your IG to Business account + link to a Facebook Page	If the agency wants to track organic IG performance

Step-by-step — opening your dashboard for the first time

Step 1: Receive the share link from the agency

The agency sends an email / message with a link like:

```
https://your-domain.com/share/a1b2c3-...-z7y8w9
```

Plus (optionally) a password.

Step 2: Open the link

- Tap or click → the dashboard loads in your browser
- If password-protected, enter it once → the browser remembers for up to 30 days (per device)
- The link works on any device — no signup, no app

Step 3: Read the dashboard

You'll see (depending on what the agency set up):

- **KPI cards** at the top — total visits, bookings, revenue, cost per booking, ROAS over the selected date range
- **Content performance** — which Instagram posts, ads, and influencer collabs drove the most bookings
- **Paid ads performance** — Meta spend, conversions, ROAS by campaign
- **Social media performance** — organic Instagram follower growth + top posts
- **Influencer impact** — coupon redemptions per influencer

Use the **date range selector** at the top to compare time windows.

Step 4: Refresh

- Bookings appear within a minute of happening
- Meta ad data refreshes hourly
- Organic Instagram data refreshes every 6 hours

Step 5: (Web admin only) If asked to install tracking

Your agency may send you the two `<script>` tags. Paste both into `<head>` of every page of your website (homepage, room pages, booking flow, confirmation page). On the confirmation page, also add an `fbq( 'Purchase' )` call with the booking value. See Step 7 of Role 2 above for the exact HTML.

Hotel owner FAQ

Q: Will this slow down my website? A: No. The HotelTrack snippet is ~2 KB and loads `async` — it never blocks the page. Meta Pixel is similar.

Q: Does this collect guest personal data? A: No. The HotelTrack snippet captures only UTM campaign params + page URL + an anonymous session ID. No names, emails, or form contents. Meta Pixel may collect more depending on what you fire — talk to the agency about Pixel privacy settings if it matters.

Q: What if I lose the link? A: Contact your agency — they can revoke + regenerate it.

Q: Why is my dashboard empty? A: Either no traffic yet, or the snippets haven't been installed. Confirm with the agency that the test booking they ran appeared.

7. Cross-references

- `docs/agency-owner-setup.md` — short version of Role 2's initial setup
- `docs/adding-a-hotel-client.md` — the per-hotel onboarding (Steps 6-12 above, expanded)
- `docs/deploying-to-vercel.md` — for the super admin's initial deploy
- `docs/deploying-to-render.md` — alternative platform deploy
- `README.md` — overview + how to run locally
- `CLAUDE.md` — project bible (multi-tenancy invariant, security rules)

Appendix — Tracking mode decision tree

Do you want HotelTrack's "which Instagram reel drove this booking" attribution?

```
|
|— YES (default, recommended)
|   └─ Install BOTH Meta Pixel + HotelTrack snippet
|       Env: NEXT_PUBLIC_TRACKING_MODE=hoteltrack
|       UI: All dashboards visible
|
|— NO (Meta ad reporting is enough)
|   └─ Install Meta Pixel only
|       Env: NEXT_PUBLIC_TRACKING_MODE=pixel
|       UI: Attribution sections hidden, FB Pixel install instructions shown
```

To switch modes: change `NEXT_PUBLIC_TRACKING_MODE` in `.env.local` (local) or in Vercel / Render env vars (prod) → **rebuild** (`NEXT_PUBLIC_*` is inlined at build time) → restart.

Document generated 2026-05-28. For the latest version, see the [GitHub repo](#).